Katarzyna Wierzbicka

Backend Engineer (FastAPI)

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SUMMARY

Mid-level backend developer focused on asynchronous APIs and data-intensive services. I enjoy clean typing, good observability and pragmatic trade-offs. Currently building recommendation endpoints for a retail platform. I read RFCs for fun and volunteer as a mentor in a local coding bootcamp for career changers, which sharpens how I explain design choices.

SKILLS

Python, FastAPI, asyncio, SQLAlchemy, Pydantic, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Docker, GitHub Actions, OpenTelemetry, mypy, Alembic, Pytest-cov

EXPERIENCE

Backend Engineer, Zawisza Retail Tech 2021 – Present

- Built FastAPI services serving product recommendations at 1,500 requests per second with p99 under 120 ms.
- Consumed Kafka topics for stock and price events and kept a denormalised read model in PostgreSQL.
- Added OpenTelemetry tracing across seven services, which made slow dependency chains visible and fixable.
- Wrote contract tests with schemathesis; breaking API changes caught before release.
- Mentor two junior engineers and run the team's fortnightly typing and linting guild.

Python Developer, Odra Software House 2018 – 2021

- Delivered REST backends for logistics clients with Flask and later FastAPI.
- Wrote ETL jobs to import supplier CSV and XML feeds, around 2 million rows a night.
- Shipped through GitHub Actions workflows that ran linting, tests and image builds on every pull request.
- Presented a lunchtime talk on database indexing that became an internal onboarding module.
- Handled a customer escalation by tracing a memory leak to an unclosed connection pool.

Part-time Python Developer, Silesia Webworks 2017 – 2018

- Built reporting scripts and a small Flask dashboard alongside university studies.
- Learned code review and agile planning in a team of four.
- Documented data models for the analysts who consumed the exports.
- Wrote a migration guide from Flask to FastAPI that three other squads used, including a checklist for dependency injection and testing.
- Joined the on-call rota and wrote concise runbooks after each incident.

EDUCATION

- MSc Computer Science, Wrocław Polytechnic of Applied Sciences (2016 – 2018)
- BSc Informatics, Wrocław Polytechnic of Applied Sciences (2013 – 2016)

LANGUAGES

Polish (native), English (C1), German (A2)

CERTIFICATIONS

- Applied Async Python, online course

- Data Modelling for Services, Odra Software House academy